

Chapter 4

The Consequences of the Mark

No One is Exempt

The unfortunate reality told by the Bible is that no one person alive on the earth during the great tribulation, the last three and a half years (Rev. 13:5; Dan. 7:25), is exempt from receiving the mark of the beast. It is written that the authority was given to the first beast, the Antichrist, from Satan over every tribe and every people and every tongue and every nation (Rev. 13:7), and power was given to the second beast, the False Prophet, to cause all, the small and great, the rich and poor, the freeman and the slaves to be given them mark (Rev. 13:16). Hence, the Bible makes it very clear that with authority over every tribe, people, tongue, and nation, and over all people, the small, the great, the rich, the poor, the free, and the slave, it is the satanic triad's absolute will to cause everyone still dwelling on the earth during the end times to receive the mark of the beast. With the significance of the mark toward the Antichrist and toward God explained earlier in this chapter through analysing the locations of the mark, let us comprehend the dire consequences of receiving the mark and the diabolical intent of Satan behind this scheme.

Dire Consequences

When Satan, the fallen archangel Lucifer saw God's creation of man, it was on his heart with every evil intent and hatred to destroy mankind by dragging man into the lake of fire to perish alongside himself, because Satan knew that the day he rebelled against God was the day that judgement was pronounced on him to be cast into the lake of fire (Isa. 14:15; Rev. 20:10), but God is patiently waiting to carry out His judgement on Satan together with man (cf. Matt. 8:29; Jude 1:14) similar to a husband waiting for his wife to get ready for a special occasion (cf. Rev. 19:7). Satan knew that the only way to delay the execution of his judgement sentence is to corrupt and destroy man, by injecting sin and death into man, constituting mankind as sinners, forcing God to destroy man Himself because His binding righteousness cannot allow evil and death to exist perpetually in His creation (Rom. 7:24; Psalms 89:14; Isaiah 33:14; Hebrews 12:29). Therefore, ever since the day man was created, Satan has not ceased his work in tempting (1 Cor. 7:5), accusing (Rev. 12:10), corrupting (Genesis 6:12), and even devouring man (1 Peter 5:8; Rev. 12:4). Undoubtedly, the diabolic goal of Satan is to ensure as many people as possible met the requirement to perish in the lake of fire, before he is finally cast into it himself. And the mark of the beast is one such requirement that seals the eternal fate of those who receive it.

Therefore, we see why the devil intends to force the mark of the beast upon everyone dwelling on the earth through his left and righthand man, so that all people may be under his possession and worship his authority and image (Rev. 14:9), and in doing so bringing judgement upon themselves. And this is precisely what is warned in the following chapter after

revelation of the mark: “If anyone worships the beast and his image and receives a mark on his forehead or on his hand, he also shall drink of the wine of the fury of God, which is mixed undiluted in the cup of His wrath; and he shall be tormented in fire and brimstone before the holy angels and before the Lamb. And the smoke of their tormenting goes up forever and ever; and they have no rest day and night, those who worship the beast and his image, and whoever receives the mark of his name” (Rev. 14:9-11). Oh what a stark warning! It is clear that whoever receives the mark of the beast will be tormented in fire and brimstone eternally. Though the warning is of those that receive the mark and worship the beast, implying two requirements, the act of receiving the mark willingly may be itself an act of worshipping the beast, as discussed in the significance of the location of the mark on the right hand.

The burning fire and brimstone is confirmed to be the lake of fire in the later chapter, as the Antichrist and the False Prophet, the two “sons of perdition” were seized and cast alive into the lake of fire, which burns with brimstone (Rev. 19:20). Though in Revelation 19:20 the people who have the mark of the beast are not explicitly mentioned to be cast into the lake of fire, it is clear that those who worshipped and received the mark are implied, and this was explicit in chapter 14: anyone who worship the beast and receive the mark shall be tormented in fire and brimstone forever and ever (Rev. 14:10-11). We see that it was never on God’s heart to send people to the lake of fire, as throughout the Bible there are three living characters, and only three living characters explicitly named by God to be cast into the lake of fire (Rev. 19:20, 20:10), the three names being: Satan, the Antichrist (the son of perdition in 2 Thes. 2:3), and the False Prophet (the son of perdition in John 17:12).

What a stark and clear warning the Lord has given to us, and to all of mankind in His word! This word of warning is not to stir up fear or distress, but a warning out of His compassions and love for us in His word to all of humanity of coming, impending, and inevitable schemes and deception of the satanic triad, of the things that will and must take place (Rev. 1:1, 4:1, 22:6) for this age to end, and Christ to return. With the word of God and the prophecies within being faithful and true (Rev. 21:5, 22:6), and the understanding of the consequences behind the mark of the beast, and the satanic triad’s absolute intention to force it upon everyone still dwelling on the earth to cause as many people as possible to perish with them in the lake of fire, let us expose how they intend to carry this scheme out.

The Mark’s Only Incentive

The mark of the beast’s only incentive is for people to regain the ability to use fiat money (or simplified as “money”, so throughout the rest of this chapter), that is, to buy and to sell. It is brutally simple and straightforward, no one may be able to buy or sell except him who has the mark. Revelation 13:17 has been the main burden of the author, as it exposes such a clever, grandiose, and diabolical scheme of the devil, and at the same time grants us the precise starting point to counter this scheme, equipped with the knowledge and intelligence of the enemy’s plans.

It is marvellous that God knows every step and plan of Satan and has unreservedly exposed them to us through His word. In this spiritual warfare, as in any warfare, intelligence on the enemy's stratagems and plans is instrumental to a victorious outcome. Therefore, concerning the mark of the beast, the kernel of the satanic triad's schemes in the end times, the following has been revealed to us through the scriptures.

The Scheme of the Mark

The rise of the Antichrist: A powerful and strong leader will rise from a gentile region around the Mediterranean Sea (Rev. 13:1), and make a deal with Satan to receive power and authority over the world (Rev. 13:2, 7), mirroring Satan's same unsuccessful offer to the true Christ in the wilderness (cf. Matt. 4:8-9). This strong man will be killed or brought close to the point of death (Rev. 13:3), most likely through assassination. And he will be healed and be resuscitated from death (Rev. 13:3&14) as a blatant imitation of Christ's death and resurrection, from then onward he will be known explicitly as the Antichrist (Rev. 13:4).

The intention of the Antichrist: The Antichrist claims to be god and above all objects of worship (2 Thes. 2:4; Dan. 11:36) and desires all to worship him (Rev. 13:8). However, he does not have the means to do so and is limited in his ability (as he still a man), he needs a partner to assist in the execution of his plans.

The rise of the False Prophet: The False Prophet arises from the earth (Rev. 13:11), signifying the land of Israel, and joins the Antichrist to exercise all the Antichrist's authority (Rev. 13:12). This time, power was given to the False Prophet to perform many great outward signs (Rev. 13:13, 15) to deceive all people into worshipping the Antichrist and receive his mark (Rev. 13:14, 16, 19:20).

The design of the mark: Undoubtedly, with all authority over the world, including the banking, financial, and commercial systems, and the expertise and prowess in monetary controllership of each one of the satanic triad, they design the mark with the following purposes:

- A sign of ownership to the Antichrist
- A symbol of worship to the Antichrist
- A visible identification that can immediately single out those not submissive to him
- A right to use money within their controlled monetary system

The intention of the mark: With the mark of the beast being a prerequisite for all people to engage in buying and selling, which is the use of money, those who are oblivious to its grave consequences will be deceived into receiving the mark (Rev. 19:20) just to buy the necessities of life to live. Whilst those who refuse to receive the mark will most likely face socio-economic death, be discriminated against and persecuted, and eventually physical death from hunger or thirst due to the inability to purchase any necessities to live, such as food and utilities.

Satan, being the source of all these schemes, intends to take as many people as possible alongside him into the lake of fire, as warned most clearly and explicitly that anyone with the

mark of the beast will suffer in the lake of fire eternally (Rev. 14:9-11). And the mark seems to be permanent and irreversible; the Bible offers no hint or possibility of salvation for those who have received it (cf. Matt. 6:24).

The Right to Use Money

The mark forces a clear choice upon all dwelling on the earth: either conform to the cult of the Antichrist and regain one's ability to use money, or face certain death from deprivation or persecution due to one's inability to use money and being easily identifiable. It will only be a matter of time before everyone alive on earth must decide whether to receive the mark and have the ability to buy food, water, and live life, or to face certain deprivation and persecution.

As noted by the German banker Mayer Rothschild: "permit me to issue and control a nation's money, and I care not who writes the laws", the truth behind this becomes ever clearer in an age of increasing financial and monetary centralisation, where money is the embodiment of status and power, digits on a screen that a financial institution tells you it is yours, rather than the underlying value of its material worth. It was Rothschild's observation that the person who controls the aggregate monetary system (and hence the money) of a nation controls the livelihood of its citizens; extrapolated further, the person who controls the aggregate monetary system of the world controls the livelihoods of all people of the world (cf. Rev. 13:7). Across all human civilisations, particularly in this day and age, the right for an individual to use money is synonymous to the right for an individual to live. As money is a means of survival through the purchase and selling of necessities, he who takes away your ability to use money takes away your ability to live.

In the early 2020s, during the COVID-19 pandemic, many businesses refused to sell or provide services if people didn't carry proof of vaccination or wear an approved face covering. Regardless of one's beliefs concerning these issues, what is to be highlighted is that there was widespread refusal of service if people didn't comply, a foreshadowing of the foreseeable consequences of the mark of the beast in the future to come. In addition, the migration into a cashless society and the increasing digitalisation of identity and money are eroding and replacing individual sovereignty with convenience. Purchasing goods and services is as simple as stretching out our hand with a tap of the card, and the world of internet banking and payment systems has integrated (or is integrating) facial recognition to unlock access to our bank accounts for greater convenience, a technology our phones already employ. Without the intention of stirring up fear against any technology that has become integral in enabling us to spend and receive money, it can be objectively observed that we are gradually being brought into a time when the mark can be more and more seamlessly integrated into society.

The mark of the beast being a prerequisite to an essential human right to survival, the right to use money, is undoubtedly the mark's ironclad design. To any person unfamiliar with the prophecies of the Bible, they can be easily deceived into receiving the mark as a means to survival (cf. Rev. 19:20) for three and a half years, not knowing that they have received

irreversible eternal judgement of the lake of fire upon themselves to perish alongside the beast in eternal perdition (Rev. 14:9-11, 19:20), having received his mark. (It aches the author's heart to write this, but such is the true and faithful word of God given to us, and to a much greater extent, God's heart; therefore He revealed this to us ahead of time, that the people still dwelling on the earth, and even God's chosen, would not be deceived).

Yet, what proves to be mark's ironclad design is also what will prove to be its fatal flaw where we can explore to arrive at its solution. By having only one grave (and seemingly impeccable) incentive for the mark of the beast, Satan made the mistake that would make any experienced engineer shake their head, having a single point of failure in the design of the mark of the beast. Satan went all-in in betting that all forms of money would either be subject to a central authority of control (e.g. fiat currencies) or be rendered useless due to the inherent dangers of being physical (e.g. precious metals) during the end times, where the mark serves as the most visible physical identification to easily target those without the mark.

So then, a solution would be akin to a form of money that exists wholly outside of current systems of the world, cannot be controlled, confiscated, corrupted, or centralised by any entity, is not permissioned to use, ideally digital and not physical, and is accessible globally to anyone without any arbitrary requirements. A medium of exchange that enables people to store value across time and transfer value across space peer-to-peer, that is, to buy and to sell, without the need for permission or requirement from another party.